

PM AND COUNCIL OF MINISTERS

RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE → APPOINTMENT → PM POWERS → COUNCIL/CABINET → RESPONSIBILITY → BUSINESS RULES → COMMITTEES → SUPPORT BODIES → POLITICAL VARIATION → ACCOUNTABILITY → PYQS → ANSWER

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure, the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g5 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 RESPONSIBLE EXECUTIVE AND CONSTITUTIONAL CHAIN

ARTICLE 74 CREATES PM-HEADED ADVICE

ARTICLE 75 CREATES RESPONSIBILITY TO LOK SABHA

ARTICLE 77 GIVES FORMAL EXPRESSION AND BUSINESS RULES

ARTICLE 78 PRESERVES THE INFORMATION BRIDGE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Article 74 creates PM-headed advice
- Article 75 creates responsibility to Lok Sabha

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Article 75 creates responsibility to Lok Sabha
- Article 77 gives formal expression and business rules

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Article 77 gives formal expression and business rules
- Article 78 preserves the information bridge

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- The President supplies constitutional form while the PM-led Council supplies politically responsible executive choice.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The President supplies constitutional form while the PM-led Council supplies politically responsible executive choice.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The President supplies constitutional form while the PM-led Council supplies politically responsible executive choice.

01

STAGE 01 PRIME MINISTER APPOINTMENT, ELIGIBILITY AND CONFIDENCE

CLEAR MAJORITY NARROWS PRESIDENTIAL CHOICE

HUNG HOUSE REQUIRES OBJECTIVE SUPPORT MATERIAL

PROMPT FLOOR TEST DETERMINES SURVIVAL

ARTICLE 75(5) ALLOWS ONLY SIX CONSECUTIVE MONTHS

Clear majority narrows presidential choice

Hung House requires objective support material

Prompt floor test determines survival

Article 75(5) allows only six consecutive months

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Clear majority narrows presidential choice
- Hung House requires objective support material

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Hung House requires objective support material
- Prompt floor test determines survival

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Prompt floor test determines survival
- Article 75(5) allows only six consecutive months

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Appointment begins government formation, but Lok Sabha confidence completes democratic authority.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Appointment begins government formation, but Lok Sabha confidence completes democratic authority.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Appointment begins government formation, but Lok Sabha confidence completes democratic authority.

02

STAGE 02 PRIME MINISTER POWERS AND PRESIDENTIAL RELATION

SELECTS MINISTERS AND ALLOCATES PORTFOLIOS

CHAIRS CABINET AND COORDINATES POLICY

ARTICLE 78 CHANNELS INFORMATION TO PRESIDENT

PARTY AND COALITION ARITHMETIC CONDITION POWER

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Selects ministers and allocates portfolios
- Chairs Cabinet and coordinates policy

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Chairs Cabinet and coordinates policy
- Article 78 channels information to President

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Article 78 channels information to President
- Party and coalition arithmetic condition power

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Prime-ministerial authority combines constitutional position with party leadership and remains conditional on confidence.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Prime-ministerial authority combines constitutional position with party leadership and remains conditional on confidence.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Prime-ministerial authority combines constitutional position with party leadership and remains conditional on confidence.

03

STAGE 03 COUNCIL, CABINET, RANKS AND THE 91ST AMENDMENT

COUNCIL IS THE WIDER CONSTITUTIONAL MINISTRY

CABINET IS THE CABINET-RANK DECISION CORE

RANKS ARE CONVENTIONAL, NOT A FOUR-RANK CONSTITUTIONAL CODE

ARTICLE 75(1A) USES TOTAL LOK SABHA MEMBERSHIP

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Council is the wider constitutional ministry
- Cabinet is the Cabinet-rank decision core

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Cabinet is the Cabinet-rank decision core
- Ranks are conventional, not a four-rank constitutional code

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Ranks are conventional, not a four-rank constitutional code
- Article 75(1A) uses total Lok Sabha membership

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- The 91st Amendment disciplines ministry size and defectors without fixing the actual size or ranks of the ministry.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The 91st Amendment disciplines ministry size and defectors without fixing the actual size or ranks of the ministry.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The 91st Amendment disciplines ministry size and defectors without fixing the actual size or ranks of the ministry.

04

STAGE 04 COLLECTIVE, INDIVIDUAL AND LEGAL RESPONSIBILITY

ARTICLE 75(3): MINISTRY STANDS OR FALLS TOGETHER

ARTICLE 75(2): PM ENFORCES INDIVIDUAL EXIT

CABINET SOLIDARITY REQUIRES PUBLIC DEFENCE OR RESIGNATION

NO UNIVERSAL COUNTERSIGNATURE DOES NOT ERASE ORDINARY LIABILITY

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Article 75(3): ministry stands or falls together
- Article 75(2): PM enforces individual exit

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Article 75(2): PM enforces individual exit
- Cabinet solidarity requires public defence or resignation

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Cabinet solidarity requires public defence or resignation
- No universal countersignature does not erase ordinary liability

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Responsibility is strongest when confidence, solidarity, personal discipline and legal accountability are kept distinct.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Responsibility is strongest when confidence, solidarity, personal discipline and legal accountability are kept distinct.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Responsibility is strongest when confidence, solidarity, personal discipline and legal accountability are kept distinct.

05

STAGE 05 ARTICLE 77 AND GOVERNMENT BUSINESS

ALLOCATION RULES ANSWER WHO HANDLES A SUBJECT

TRANSACTION RULES ANSWER HOW IMPORTANT CASES MOVE

DEFINED CASES ESCALATE TO PM, COMMITTEES, CABINET OR PRESIDENT

AUTHENTICATION IS NOT PERSONAL PRESIDENTIAL DECISION

Allocation Rules answer who handles a subject

Transaction Rules answer how important cases move

Defined cases escalate to PM, committees, Cabinet or President

Authentication is not personal presidential decision

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Allocation Rules answer who handles a subject
- Transaction Rules answer how important cases move

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Transaction Rules answer how important cases move
- Defined cases escalate to PM, committees, Cabinet or President

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Defined cases escalate to PM, committees, Cabinet or President
- Authentication is not personal presidential decision

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Article 77 turns political direction into traceable departmental action through allocation, consultation and escalation.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Article 77 turns political direction into traceable departmental action through allocation, consultation and escalation.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Article 77 turns political direction into traceable departmental action through allocation, consultation and escalation.

06

STAGE 06 CABINET COMMITTEES AND CURRENT CONTROL

STANDING AND AD HOC COMMITTEES SPECIALISE CABINET WORK

CABINET RETAINS THE COLLECTIVE-RESPONSIBILITY FRAME

NUMBER, MEMBERSHIP AND CHAIRS VARY BY NOTIFICATION

OFFICIAL COMPOSITION DOCUMENT IS DATED 27 JULY 2026

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Standing and ad hoc committees specialise Cabinet work
- Cabinet retains the collective-responsibility frame

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Cabinet retains the collective-responsibility frame
- Number, membership and chairs vary by notification

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Number, membership and chairs vary by notification
- Official composition document is dated 27 July 2026

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Cabinet Committees improve specialisation, but current composition must come from the dated official notification.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Cabinet Committees improve specialisation, but current composition must come from the dated official notification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cabinet Committees improve specialisation, but current composition must come from the dated official notification.

07

STAGE 07 CABINET SECRETARIAT, PMO AND INFORMAL SUPPORT

CABINET SECRETARIAT ADMINISTERS BUSINESS RULES

IT RECORDS, COORDINATES AND MONITORS CABINET DECISIONS

PMO IS NON-CONSTITUTIONAL STAFF SUPPORT WITHOUT INDEPENDENT COMPETENCE

KITCHEN CABINET AND GOMS ARE INFORMAL OR AD HOC MECHANISMS

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Cabinet Secretariat administers business rules
- It records, coordinates and monitors Cabinet decisions

OPERATING MECHANISM

- It records, coordinates and monitors Cabinet decisions
- PMO is non-constitutional staff support without independent competence

CHECK OR LIMIT

- PMO is non-constitutional staff support without independent competence
- Kitchen Cabinet and GoMs are informal or ad hoc mechanisms

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Coordination bodies assist the formal executive but cannot replace ministerial competence or parliamentary responsibility.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Coordination bodies assist the formal executive but cannot replace ministerial competence or parliamentary responsibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Coordination bodies assist the formal executive but cannot replace ministerial competence or parliamentary responsibility.

08

STAGE 08 CARETAKER, COALITION AND CONTINUITY

PM RESIGNATION OR DEATH ENDS THE MINISTRY POLITICALLY

ARTICLE 74 REQUIRES CONTINUITY UNTIL SUCCESSOR ASSUMES OFFICE

COALITION BARGAINING AFFECTS SOLIDARITY, NOT ARTICLE 75(3)

CARETAKER RESTRAINT IS CONVENTION, NOT A SEPARATE CONSTITUTIONAL CODE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- PM resignation or death ends the ministry politically
- Article 74 requires continuity until successor assumes office

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Article 74 requires continuity until successor assumes office
- Coalition bargaining affects solidarity, not Article 75(3)

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Coalition bargaining affects solidarity, not Article 75(3)
- Caretaker restraint is convention, not a separate constitutional code

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Political arithmetic changes the intensity of PM power, while constitutional continuity and confidence remain constant.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Political arithmetic changes the intensity of PM power, while constitutional continuity and confidence remain constant.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Political arithmetic changes the intensity of PM power, while constitutional continuity and confidence remain constant.

09

STAGE 09 PARLIAMENTARY ACCOUNTABILITY AND PRIME-MINISTERIAL GOVERNMENT

QUESTION HOUR, COMMITTEES, FINANCE AND AUDIT CREATE SCRUTINY

NO-CONFIDENCE SUPPLIES THE COLLECTIVE SANCTION

WHIP AND TENTH SCHEDULE MAY COMPRESS LEGISLATIVE AUTONOMY

COURTS, FEDERALISM, ELECTIONS AND CABINET COLLEAGUES CONSTRAIN DOMINANCE

Question Hour, committees, finance and audit create scrutiny

No-confidence supplies the collective sanction

Whip and Tenth Schedule may compress legislative autonomy

Courts, federalism, elections and Cabinet colleagues constrain dominance

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Question Hour, committees, finance and audit create scrutiny
- No-confidence supplies the collective sanction

OPERATING MECHANISM

- No-confidence supplies the collective sanction
- Whip and Tenth Schedule may compress legislative autonomy

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Whip and Tenth Schedule may compress legislative autonomy
- Courts, federalism, elections and Cabinet colleagues constrain dominance

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- India shows a prime-ministerial tendency within cabinet government, not a legal replacement of cabinet government.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — India shows a prime-ministerial tendency within cabinet government, not a legal replacement of cabinet government.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: India shows a prime-ministerial tendency within cabinet government, not a legal replacement of cabinet government.

10

STAGE 10 PYQ AND PRELIMS TRAP ROUTES

SHAMSHER SINGH (1974): RESPONSIBLE ADVICE

S.R. CHAUDHURI (2001): SIX-MONTH RULE CANNOT BE SERIALIZED

2024 GS-II Q3 ASKS HOW CABINET GROWTH MARGINALISES SCRUTINY

ARTICLE 88 GIVES PARTICIPATION, NOT A VOTE WITHOUT MEMBERSHIP

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Shamsher Singh (1974) anchors responsible ministerial advice
- S.R. Chaudhuri (2001) bars serial abuse of the six-month rule

OPERATING MECHANISM

- S.R. Chaudhuri (2001) bars serial abuse of the six-month rule
- 2024 GS-II Q3 asks how Cabinet growth marginalises scrutiny

CHECK OR LIMIT

- 2024 GS-II Q3 asks how Cabinet growth marginalises scrutiny
- Article 88 gives participation, not a vote without membership

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- High-scoring responses identify the exact provision, reject frozen counts and separate Union rules from State analogues.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — High-scoring responses identify the exact provision, reject frozen counts and separate Union rules from State analogues.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: High-scoring responses identify the exact provision, reject frozen counts and separate Union rules from State analogues.

11

STAGE 11 ANSWER EXECUTION, REFORM AND QUALIFIED VERDICT

10 MARKS: PROVISION, MECHANISM, LIMITATION, VERDICT

15 MARKS: ADD INSTITUTIONAL CHAIN AND NAMED EVIDENCE

20 MARKS: BALANCE CONCENTRATION AGAINST COUNTERWEIGHTS

REFORMS MUST TARGET WHIP, SCRUTINY, PMO SUBSIDIARITY AND TRACEABILITY

10 marks: provision, mechanism, limitation, verdict

15 marks: add institutional chain and named evidence

20 marks: balance concentration against counterweights

Reforms must target whip, scrutiny, PMO subsidiarity and traceability

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- 10 marks: provision, mechanism, limitation, verdict
- 15 marks: add institutional chain and named evidence

OPERATING MECHANISM

- 15 marks: add institutional chain and named evidence
- 20 marks: balance concentration against counterweights

CHECK OR LIMIT

- 20 marks: balance concentration against counterweights
- Reforms must target whip, scrutiny, PMO subsidiarity and traceability

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Strong executive coordination earns constitutional legitimacy only when each decision remains traceable to collective responsibility.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Strong executive coordination earns constitutional legitimacy only when each decision remains traceable to collective responsibility.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Strong executive coordination earns constitutional legitimacy only when each decision remains traceable to collective responsibility.

E

EXTRA OPTIONAL ENRICHMENT — NOT REQUIRED FOR A COMPETENT CORE ANSWER

CROSSMAN AND MACKINTOSH SUPPLY ANALYTICAL LABELS

MORLEY AND JENNINGS ARE ATTRIBUTED CHARACTERISATIONS

COMPARATIVE WESTMINSTER PRACTICE CAN REFINA EVALUATION

NONE OF THIS ENRICHMENT REPAIRS MISSING CORE DOCTRINE

CONSTITUTIONAL BASIS

- Crossman and Mackintosh supply analytical labels
- Morley and Jennings are attributed characterisations

OPERATING MECHANISM

- Morley and Jennings are attributed characterisations
- Comparative Westminster practice can refine evaluation

CHECK OR LIMIT

- Comparative Westminster practice can refine evaluation
- None of this enrichment repairs missing Core doctrine

EXAM CONSEQUENCE

- Optional scholarship may refine a strong answer but is unnecessary for a competent Core answer.

OPTIONAL STATUS — Optional scholarship may refine a strong answer but is unnecessary for a competent Core answer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Optional scholarship may refine a strong answer but is unnecessary for a competent Core answer.